UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

WEDNESDAY, 07 OCTOBER 2026

12 must-know stories, 18 Prelims facts, 18 editorials and 14 explainers, picked from 945 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

CJI agrees to take a call on hearing a plea to recall split verdict in CEC appointments law case

The Supreme Court agreed to examine a plea seeking the recall of a recent split verdict on referring challenges to the 2023 CEC appointments law to a larger Constitution Bench. Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan informed a bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant about the recall application. The core legal debate involves challenges to the 2023 law governing the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners, specifically the exclusion of the CJI from the selection panel. A two-judge bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma delivered separate opinions on September 23 regarding reference to a larger bench. Justice Dipankar Datta declined the Centre's request for a larger bench, whereas Justice Satish Chandra Sharma favoured placing the matter before one. Following the split opinion, the matter was placed before the CJI on the administrative side to constitute an appropriate bench. Counsel stated that a separate curative petition has also been filed alongside the interlocutory application seeking judgment recall. Subsequent to the September 23 verdict, media reports had alleged that Justice Sharma's son served as a standing counsel for the ECI.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** CJI Surya Kant, Justices Joymalya Bagchi, V Mohana, Dipankar Datta, Satish Chandra Sharma, and Gopal Sankaranarayanan · **Prelims:** The split verdict was delivered on September 23 by Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma.; Justice Dipankar Datta declined the Centre's request for reference to a larger bench, while Justice Satish Chandra Sharma favoured it.; A separate curative petition was filed alongside the interlocutory application seeking the recall of the judgment.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It directly impacts the ongoing legal scrutiny over the independence of appointments to the Election Commission of India.; It raises procedural questions regarding the maintainability of recall applications and curative petitions in matters of split verdicts.*

Static — The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 governs the appointment process of top poll panels. Article 324 of the Constitution of India provides for the superintendence, direction, and control of elections to be vested in an Election Commission. A Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court requires a minimum of five judges under Article 145(3) of the Constitution to interpret substantial questions of law.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment, Report/Index, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on news18.com · also reported by ETV Bharat, Open Magazine, Rediff, Law Trend, Scroll, Bar & Bench, Hindustan Times, Republic World, The New Indian Express

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

New rural jobs framework notifies 375 activities

The Centre notified 375 types of works under the new rural employment framework, expanding permissible works by 41%. Works are divided into four categories under the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission Gramin Act, 2025. Water security comprises 128 works, core rural infrastructure has 111, livelihood-related infrastructure has 98, and disaster preparedness has 38. Livelihood-related infrastructure now accounts for 26% of total works, up from 1.1% in the previous framework. The framework includes infrastructure for self-help groups, agro-processing units, cold storage facilities, and solar street lights. Disaster preparedness works cover flood relief shelters, embankment strengthening, and forest-fire management measures. Gram panchayats will plan works via Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans, requiring Gram Sabha approval and digital monitoring. The VB-G RAM G Act took effect on July 1, replacing MGNREGA to provide 125 days of guaranteed wage employment annually.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Rural Development · **Prelims:** Total number of notified works is 375.; The act behind the framework is the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission Gramin Act, 2025.; Guaranteed wage employment provided is 125 days per rural household each year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands rural work options by 41% with a major push toward livelihood-related infrastructure and asset creation.; Introduces dedicated focus on disaster preparedness, climate resilience, and water security in rural areas.*

Static — Rural employment guarantee frameworks aim to enhance livelihood security in rural areas by providing guaranteed wage employment for unskilled manual work. Gram Panchayats play a central role in grassroot planning, project identification, and implementation of rural developmental works under local governance laws. Centrally sponsored schemes typically involve cost-sharing mechanisms between the Union government and states based on predetermined funding ratios.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy, Economy, Disaster Management · Prelims angle: Scheme, Act/Bill/Rules

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on cnbctv18.com

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana (PMKKKY)

The scheme remains in news due to continuous utilization and monitoring of DMF funds for local development in mining districts. Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana is a flagship welfare scheme utilizing District Mineral Foundation funds to develop and aid mining-affected areas.

When: 2015 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Mines, District Mineral Foundations · **Prelims:** PMKKKY was launched by the Ministry of Mines.; It is implemented using District Mineral Foundation (DMF) funds.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures direct translation of mineral wealth into local human development and infrastructure.; Addresses environmental degradation and health hazards faced by communities residing near mining belts.*

Static — PMKKKY was launched in 2015 by the Ministry of Mines, Government of India. District Mineral Foundations (DMFs) are statutory bodies established in mining districts under the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2015. DMFs are funded through contributions from mining lease holders based on a prescribed percentage of royalty.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

PIB: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

16th India-Japan Annual Summit Joint Statement | Ministry of External Affairs , Government of India

The publication of the official joint statement from the 16th India-Japan Annual Summit. The Ministry of External Affairs released the joint statement following the 16th India-Japan Annual Summit.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** India and Japan · **Who:** Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India · **Prelims:** Event: 16th India-Japan Annual Summit Joint Statement; Issuing Body: Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the deepening geopolitical and economic alignment between India and Japan.; Reinforces shared strategic interests in the Indo-Pacific region.*

Static — India and Japan established diplomatic relations in 1952, which were elevated to a Global and Strategic Partnership in 2006. The Annual Summit mechanism between the Prime Ministers of India and Japan was instituted in 2006 to review bilateral ties. India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership focuses on regional security, economic cooperation, and democratic values.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Ministry of External Affairs: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, New Zealand sign 10 agreements, unveil Strategic Partnership Roadmap to 2030

India and New Zealand signed 10 agreements and unveiled a Strategic Partnership Roadmap to 2030 to enhance bilateral cooperation. The agreements and roadmap were established to deepen diplomatic, economic, and strategic ties between the two nations. The core initiative focuses on expanding collaboration across multiple sectors outlined in the 10 agreements. Both countries aim to strengthen their bilateral engagement through this structured framework leading up to the year 2030. The partnership highlights mutual interests in regional stability and economic growth between India and New Zealand. Specific details of the 10 agreements span various governmental and economic domains. The roadmap sets clear milestones for bilateral cooperation over the coming years. Implications include stronger diplomatic ties and increased trade and collaborative opportunities between India and New Zealand.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** India and New Zealand · **Who:** India and New Zealand governments · **Prelims:** Number of agreements signed: 10; Roadmap unveiled: Strategic Partnership Roadmap to 2030

> ***Why it matters —*** *It enhances diplomatic and economic engagement between India and New Zealand.; The 2030 roadmap provides a clear strategic direction for bilateral ties.*

Static — India and New Zealand share warm and friendly relations based on common ties of the Commonwealth and democratic traditions. New Zealand has a significant Indian diaspora community that contributes to its multicultural society and bilateral links. Both nations engage through various multilateral forums and platforms to discuss regional security and trade.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by Business Standard

Health

GS2 MAKE NOTES

National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) notifies regulations for autonomous boards and central assessment committee to strengthen quality, transparency and standardisation in allied and healthcare education

The National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions notified regulations for autonomous boards, a central assessment committee, and professional registration. The regulations aim to strengthen quality assurance, standardisation, transparency, and competency-based education in the allied and healthcare sector. Autonomous Boards under State Councils will handle education, institutional assessment, professional ethics, and registration with 10-20 members. An Assessment and Rating Board will evaluate applications, conduct inspections, review annual disclosures, and rate institutions. An Ethics and Registration Board will verify documents, recommend registration, and handle complaints and violations. A Central Assessment Committee with 10-30 members will perform board functions in states without functional state councils. A competency-based curriculum for the Diploma in Medical Radiology and Imaging Technology was notified under the One Nation One Curriculum initiative. The Registration regulations introduce digital registration with unique identification numbers and secure QR-coded certificates valid for five years.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) · **Prelims:** The National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions Act was enacted in 2021.; Autonomous Boards under state councils comprise 10 to 20 members.; The Central Assessment Committee comprises 10 to 30 members.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It establishes uniform standards and quality assurance mechanisms across allied and healthcare institutions nationwide.; The digital registration system with unique ID numbers and QR-coded certificates prevents unqualified practice and aids public verification.*

Static — The Act establishes a central commission and state councils to regulate qualifications, professional conduct, maintenance of central and state registers, and standardisation of education. Allied and healthcare professionals include individuals performing diagnostic, curative, rehabilitative, therapeutic, or preventive health services. Competency-based medical and healthcare education focuses on developing specific, measurable skills and practical clinical competencies rather than rote theoretical learning.

Syllabus: GS2: Health, Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution, Education · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

PIB: read the source · free copy on theprint.in

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI MPC Meeting Oct 2026 Highlights: RBI MPC hikes repo rate by 25 bps to 5.5%, changes stance to 'calibrated tightening'

The Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee increased the policy repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5% on Wednesday. This move marks the beginning of a new monetary tightening cycle triggered by turbulent international commodity and capital markets. The core issue is balancing domestic economic resilience against external shocks, including geopolitical tensions in West Asia and surging global bond yields. Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that inflation and its outlook are no longer benign, citing pressures from deficient monsoons and El Nino conditions. The MPC changed its policy stance from neutral to 'calibrated tightening', meaning rates will either be held constant or hiked, but not reduced. India's real GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 7.1%, which is 40 basis points higher than the previous August forecast. Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation for the full fiscal year is projected higher at 5.2%, with core inflation expected to grow at 4.4%. Quarterly GDP growth is projected at 7.2%, 6.9%, 6.8%, and 7.1% for the quarters ending September 2026 through June 2027. Economists expect further rate hikes in coming months, potentially pushing the repo rate higher to manage lingering inflationary pressures.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India Monetary Policy Committee, Governor Sanjay Malhotra · **Prelims:** The repo rate was hiked by 25 basis points to 5.5% in October 2026.; India's GDP growth for 2026-27 is projected at 7.1%.; Full fiscal year CPI inflation is projected at 5.2%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Makes corporate and retail loans, including home mortgages, more expensive for borrowers.; Signals a decisive shift by the central bank toward managing external vulnerabilities and stubborn domestic inflation.*

Static — The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) is a statutory body constituted under Section 45ZB of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, to fix the benchmark policy interest rate. The MPC comprises six members: three official members from the RBI (including the Governor as chairperson) and three external members appointed by the central government. Under the RBI Act, the central bank aims to maintain price stability while keeping in mind the objective of economic growth, targeting a CPI inflation rate of 4% with a band of +/- 2%.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on hindustantimes.com · also reported by Economic Times, Mint, RBI, Sanskriti IAS, Moneycontrol.com, BBC, CNBC, Business Standard, Outlook Money, CNBC TV18, ThePrint, Reuters, Facebook

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre approves Rs. 10K-crore SME growth fund

The Union cabinet approved a Rs. 10,000 crore SME Growth Fund to provide equity support to promising small and medium enterprises. The approval comes ahead of the 57th GST Council meeting expected to consider major process reforms for businesses. The fund was proposed in the Union budget by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman to create Champion MSMEs. The fund targets enterprises in manufacturing, services, technology, and innovation-driven sectors. Existing funds mostly focus on early-stage micro enterprises, creating a structural gap for equity growth capital for SMEs. SMEs face a shortage of long-term risk capital needed to scale up, innovate, expand overseas, and adopt advanced technologies. The SME Growth Fund aims to address this financing gap by providing patient growth equity capital to high-potential SMEs.

When: Tuesday · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Nirmala Sitharaman, GST Council · **Prelims:** The SME Growth Fund has a corpus of Rs. 10,000 crore.; The fund was proposed in the February 1 budget speech by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.; The 57th GST Council meeting is chaired by Nirmala Sitharaman.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Addresses the shortage of long-term risk capital faced by Indian SMEs.; Aids in creating Champion MSMEs by incentivizing enterprises based on select criteria.*

Static — MSMEs are categorized in India based on investment in plant and machinery or equipment and annual turnover under the MSME Development Act. The Union Cabinet is the apex decision-making body of the executive headed by the Prime Minister of India. GST Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A, chaired by the Union Finance Minister with state finance ministers as members.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by Medical Buyer, Insights on India

GS3 MAKE NOTES

GST Council may weigh wider data sharing, rare disease tax relief on Thursday

The GST Council is meeting on Thursday to discuss these proposals. The GST Council is set to review proposals for wider sharing of GST data to serve as official economic statistics alongside considering tax relief for rare diseases. The data-sharing proposal assumes significance as any such move could take the GST data beyond its traditional role for tax administration and make it a regular input for official economic statistics.

When: Thursday · **Who:** GST Council · **Prelims:** The GST Council meeting is scheduled for Thursday.; Proposals include wider data sharing and rare disease tax relief.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It could expand the utility of GST administrative data for national economic policymaking and statistics.; Tax relief on rare diseases addresses critical public health and affordability concerns for patients.*

Static — The Goods and Services Tax Council is a constitutional body established under Article 279A of the Constitution of India. The Council is chaired by the Union Finance Minister and includes ministers in charge of finance or taxation from all states. It makes recommendations to the Union and State Governments on important issues related to GST rates, exemptions, and thresholds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Health

Mint: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, Business Standard

Environment & Ecology

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

COP31 should focus on Closing Gaps, Fulfilling Commitments and Accelerating Implementation of Paris Agreement, stresses India

Union Minister Shri Bhupender Yadav addressed the plenary discussion on COP31 priorities at the UNFCCC Pre-COP31 meeting in Fiji. He called for greater focus on closing gaps in understanding, fulfilling existing climate commitments, and accelerating implementation of the Paris Agreement. The Minister is leading the Indian Delegation at the UNFCCC Pre-COP31 meeting co-hosted by Australia, Fiji, and Tuvalu. Shri Yadav saluted the spirit of the people of Tuvalu for bravely combating climate change challenges and setting a successful model. He noted that long-term goals like limiting global temperature rise to 1.5 degrees Celsius are already established under the UNFCCC and Paris Agreement. The Minister emphasized identifying and developing consensus on gaps between science, traditional knowledge, community practices, ethics, and resources. On decision-making, he urged parties to fulfil their commitments under the UNFCCC and Paris Agreement in true letter and spirit. On implementation, he called for addressing identified gaps where the need is highest and impact is felt by the majority.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** Fiji · **Who:** Shri Bhupender Yadav · **Prelims:** Shri Bhupender Yadav led the Indian Delegation at the UNFCCC Pre-COP31 meeting.; The Pre-COP31 meeting was co-hosted by Australia, Fiji, and Tuvalu.; The meeting venue for this Pre-COP31 discussion was in Fiji.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces India's proactive stance on climate multilateralism and equity.; Highlights the importance of traditional knowledge and closing resource gaps for developing nations.*

Static — The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) was signed in 1992 at the Rio Earth Summit to stabilize greenhouse gas concentrations. The Conference of the Parties (COP) is the supreme decision-making body of the UNFCCC, meeting annually to assess global climate action. The Paris Agreement, adopted at COP21 in 2015, legally binds parties to hold the increase in global average

temperature to well below 2 degrees Celsius.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

PIB: read the source · free copy on ddnews.gov.in · also reported by The Hawk

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Rewilding the Great Indian Bustard: Key Challenges

Two captive-bred male Great Indian Bustards were released into the wild for the first time in Rajasthan's Desert National Park on October 4, 2026. The initiative is part of Project GIB undertaken by the Centre, the Wildlife Institute of India, and the governments of Rajasthan and Gujarat. Since 2019, wild GIB eggs have been collected and hand-reared at centres in Rajasthan, resulting in the birth of 98 birds so far. Soft-release facilities and rewilding aviaries were developed to help young birds adapt to natural conditions and avoid human imprinting. The released birds are fitted with transmitters to track their locations, movement patterns, adaptation, and survival. Major threats to the species include habitat loss from cropland conversion, limestone mining, unsuitable afforestation, and power-line collisions. The Supreme Court has ordered 80 km of power lines in Rajasthan to be buried underground by 2027-28 to protect GIB priority areas. With only around 150 GIBs remaining in the wild, the success of rewilding depends on rigorous habitat protection and community involvement.

When: October 4, 2026 · **Where:** Desert National Park, Jaisalmer, Rajasthan · **Who:** Centre, Wildlife Institute of India, and governments of Rajasthan and Gujarat · **Prelims:** Two captive-bred male GIBs were released on October 4, 2026.; The release took place in Rajasthan's Desert National Park near Jaisalmer.; Conservation breeding efforts have resulted in the birth of 98 birds so far since 2019.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Marks a major milestone in recovering a critically endangered endemic bird species from the brink of extinction.; Tests the viability of scientific captive breeding, soft-release aviaries, and transmitter-based monitoring for future conservation.*

Static — The Great Indian Bustard (Ardeotis nigriceps) is one of the heaviest flying birds, native to the Indian subcontinent. It is classified as Critically Endangered on the IUCN Red List and listed in Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972. The species primarily inhabits arid and semi-arid grasslands, scrublands, and open plains across India and Pakistan.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Species

ForumIAS: read the source

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Defence Ministry signs Rs. 660 crore contract with BrahMos Aerospace for Navy

The Ministry of Defence signed a contract worth over 660 crore rupees with BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited. The contract was signed for the procurement of BrahMos Fire Control System and Launchers for Indian Navy ships. The deal was inked under the Buy Indian-IDDM category in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh. The project features a minimum of 68% indigenous content to encourage participation from Indian industries including MSMEs. The BrahMos system serves as the Indian Navy's primary surface-to-surface missile system for maritime strike operations. This procurement aims to bolster India's maritime security architecture and overall defence capabilities.

When: 2026-10-07 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Ministry of Defence, BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited, Rajesh Kumar Singh · **Prelims:** Contract value is over 660 crore rupees.; Procurement category is Buy (Indian-Indigenously Designed, Developed and Manufactured).; Minimum indigenous content required is 68%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts indigenous defence manufacturing by involving domestic industries and MSMEs with 68% indigenous content.; Strengthens the Indian Navy's frontline combat readiness and primary surface-to-surface strike capabilities.*

Static — BrahMos Aerospace is a joint venture between India's Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya. The name BrahMos is formed from two rivers: the Brahmaputra in India and the Moskva in Russia. BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile that can be launched from submarines, ships, aircraft, or land platforms.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

newsonair.gov.in: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

India and Ghana Sign Historic MoU to Advance Agricultural Research, Education, and Technology Transfer

India and Ghana signed a five-year Memorandum of Understanding to strengthen cooperation in agricultural research, education, and technology transfer. The agreement was signed between the Indian Council of Agricultural Research and the Crops Research Institute of Ghana. The signing ceremony in Accra was attended by External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar and Ghana Foreign Minister Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Ghana’s bid to join BRICS

Ghana has received Cabinet approval to formally apply for membership of the BRICS economic bloc. Foreign Affairs Minister Samuel Okudzeto Ablakwa announced the decision during Indian External Affairs Minister Dr Subrahmanyam Jaishankar's official visit. The move aims to diversify Ghana's economic base and expand its partnerships within the Global South. Ghana has reached out to India for assistance and backing with its BRICS membership application process.

msn.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME QUICK READ

NCSC Intervention Results in Mandatory Reporting of SC Beneficiaries under Key Financial Schemes

Following an intervention by the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC), the Department of Financial Services (DFS) directed SLBCs and UTLBCs to mandatorily report SC beneficiary data. The directive was triggered after NCSC Secretary Vivek Kumar Dewangan wrote to the DFS secretary on September 24 highlighting the absence of SC family percentages in SLBC reports.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

DDWS Organised Regional Review Meeting of States/UTs under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 at IIM Bangalore

The Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation organised a regional review meeting under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 at IIM Bangalore on 7 October 2026. The meeting was convened to review implementation progress and discuss key reform measures including source sustainability and water quality surveillance. The session was chaired by Ashok K. K. Meena, Secretary of DDWS, alongside Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary and Mission Director of NJJM.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

India's green economy can support 1.3 crore jobs by 2035 but challenges remain: Report

A new iFOREST report titled India’s Green Jobs Moment warns that India's green economy could support 1.3 crore jobs by 2035. The core issue highlighted is a persistent gap between education, vocational training, and industry requirements hindering green employment. The report estimates green sectors will support 98.5 lakh jobs by 2030 and rise to nearly 1.3 crore by 2035.

Economic Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Adopted Joint Statement after the India-UK Financial Markets Dialogue 2026, held in London

India and the UK held the fourth UK-India Financial Markets Dialogue in London on September 29, 2026, adopting a joint statement. The dialogue was led by senior officials from India's Ministry of Finance and the UK's HM Treasury with financial regulators. Both nations agreed to explore boosting cross-border investments and Indian firms' access to global capital via GIFT IFSC.

PIB: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY AWARD QUICK READ

Chemistry Nobel 2026 awarded to Henri B. Kagan and Kenso Soai

The Nobel Prize in Chemistry for 2026 was awarded to Henri B. Kagan and Kenso Soai. They received the prestigious honor for discovering non-linear effects and autocatalysis in asymmetric organic synthesis. The announcement was made by the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences in Stockholm on Wednesday. Their pioneering work helps chemistry choose a specific mirror image during molecular synthesis.

Hindustan Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Two cheetahs released into tiger reserve, their third habitat in Madhya Pradesh

Chief Minister Mohan Yadav scheduled to release two cheetahs into Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve on Wednesday. The transfer marks the third habitat for cheetahs in Madhya Pradesh after Kuno National Park and Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary. Special arrangements including a secure 439-hectare area with modern enclosures called bomas were prepared for the cheetahs.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

RBI to firm up views on Irdai's proposed insurance commission overhaul

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated that the Reserve Bank of India has not yet firmed up its view on Irdai's proposed changes to insurance distributor commissions. The RBI Governor noted that the proposals appear aimed at protecting consumers by lowering costs, curbing mis-selling, and regulating product distribution.

Business Standard: source

DEFENCE QUICK READ

Raksha Mantri approves Revised Standard Operating Procedure for Utilisation of MoD Proof Ranges, Field Firing Ranges & Test Facilities by Indian Defence Industry

The revised SOP was approved to promote Atmanirbharta in defence and facilitate ease of doing business for indigenous manufacturers. The Defence Minister approved a revised Standard Operating Procedure allowing the Indian defence industry easier access to Ministry of Defence testing ranges and laboratories.

PIB: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

NCLT approved 107 resolution plans worth Rs 11,000 crore in Q2

The National Company Law Tribunal approved a record 107 resolution plans in the second quarter of FY27, which is the highest-ever quarterly approval tally. The resolution plans approved during the July-September quarter were worth over Rs 11,000 crore, significantly higher than the 60 plans approved in the same quarter last year.

Economic Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

India’s First High-Altitude Snow Leopard Safari Launched in Ladakh

India's first high-altitude wildlife safari focused on snow leopards was launched in Ladakh with the flagging off of six vehicles by Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena. The initiative aims to promote responsible wildlife tourism, community-based conservation, and sustainable livelihoods for local youth and communities. The decision to introduce the safari was announced on August 5 and executed within two months by the Snow Leopard and High-Altitude Nature Conservation (SHAN) Society.

Times of India: source

ECONOMY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

RBI issues Amendment Directions on 'Standardised Approach for Counterparty Credit Risk (SA-CCR)’

The Reserve Bank of India issued the Reserve Bank of India Amendment Directions, 2026, regarding the Standardised Approach for Counterparty Credit Risk. The central bank had previously issued draft amendment directions on June 10, 2026, to invite stakeholder feedback until July 1, 2026. Stakeholders suggested setting a quantitative threshold to identify banks with negligible derivative exposure, allowing them to apply the Current Exposure Method.

RBI: source

ECONOMY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Exclusion of “Paytm Payments Bank Limited” from the Second Schedule to the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934

The Reserve Bank of India has excluded Paytm Payments Bank Limited from the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. This decision follows the Delhi High Court ordering the winding up of PPBL under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 and Companies Act, 2013. The Delhi High Court appointed former SBI Chief General Manager Girikumar M Nair as the Official Liquidator for the winding up process.

RBI: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Manipur Unified (Trade, Shop and Establishment Licensing) Act, 2026

The Act was recently tracked and published by PRS Legislative Research. The Manipur Unified Trade Shop and Establishment Licensing Act, 2026 creates a consolidated licensing framework for commercial entities in Manipur.

PRS Legislative Research: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New species of extinct crocodilian, similar to North India’s ‘gharial’, discovered in Egypt: Study

Scientists discovered a new species of extinct crocodilian in rock used to build the Sphinx of Giza in Egypt. The newly identified animal is similar to the modern gharial found in the rivers of North India. Researchers used computed tomography to examine the inside of a fossilized skull originally found in the 1920s.

downtoearth.org.in: source

HEALTH QUICK READ

WHO releases first global guidelines on child obesity as cases surge

Child and adolescent obesity has quadrupled since 1990, rising from two per cent to around eight per cent among youngsters aged five to 19. In 2024, approximately 170 million children and adolescents were living with obesity, including 70 million aged five to nine and 100 million adolescents. The WHO defines obesity as a chronic, relapsing disease triggered by excessive fat deposits that can be managed through effective care.

UN News: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

AP Cabinet approves policy to attract foreign, private universities

The Andhra Pradesh State Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu, approved a new policy to attract foreign higher educational institutions and leading private universities. The decision was taken during a cabinet meeting held at the Secretariat on Wednesday. The Andhra Pradesh Policy for Promotion of Foreign Higher Educational Institutions (FHEIs) and Private Universities, 2026 aims to facilitate campus establishments without state financial burden.

newindianexpress.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: India's Climate Resilience Framework

A collaborative scientific study by IMD, NCMRWF, and Atria University evaluated five decades of empirical data from 1971 to 2022 to assess climate extremes. The study synthesized seven atmospheric and hydrological variables into a consolidated metric known as the India Climate Extremes Index. Climate change in India is highly heterogeneous, with different geographical regions facing distinct, compounding extreme events rather than uniform temperature rises.

Insights on India

GS2 Transparency can bolster trust in government data

Numbers as consequential as India's GDP must command public trust, which depends on making methodology and data sources accessible for independent expert examination. Over the last decade, several publicly funded surveys like NFHS-6 and the Seventh Economic Census faced severe release delays or were withheld entirely. The 2017-18 Household Consumer Expenditure Survey was never released due to cited data-quality problems and leaked findings of declining rural consumption.

Hindustan Times

GS3 RBI's rate hike matters. Its shift to calibrated tightening matters more

The Reserve Bank of India raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5% on Wednesday, marking its first rate hike since February 2023. The central bank unexpectedly shifted its policy stance from neutral to calibrated tightening, signaling room for further rate hikes due to rising inflation. Experts note that the shift to calibrated tightening is more significant than the rate hike itself because it firmly rules out near-term rate cuts.

Economic Times

GS3 Indian Research Can Shape the World

National laboratories in India need liberation from insularity to increase accessibility for external researchers, students, and companies. The bulk of national labs in the country are currently poorly accessible to individuals outside their immediate walls. The core issue revolves around opening institutional boundaries to foster broader collaboration and innovation. Greater openness can bridge the gap between academic research and practical industry applications. Insularity within scientific institutions limits the potential impact of public research investments.

The Hindu

GS3 RBI has hiked the repo rate at last but can its monetary policy committee make up for lost time?

The RBI finally announced a hike in the repo rate after waiting and watching economic conditions for 18 months. The Reserve Bank of India has raised its repo rate after a prolonged 18-month period of maintaining status quo. Whether it will succeed in taming inflation without having to pay too high a price, though, remains to be seen.

Mint

GS3 Nurturing a tiger economy, literally

The recent reintroduction of a tigress in Buxa Tiger Reserve brought the conservation initiative and its economic linkages into the news. The editorial discusses the reintroduction of a tigress in Buxa Tiger Reserve and its potential to foster a sustainable tiger economy through tourism and local industries. The reintroduction of a tigress in Buxa Tiger Reserve marks a significant step in conservation efforts. This initiative aims to create a sustainable ecosystem that supports the local economy and tiger population.

Economic Times

GS2 GS3 Gender inclusive trade agreements for women-led structural transformation in India

Women's full participation in economic activities is recognized as a defining driver of sustainable and inclusive growth. IMF estimates suggest that women's economic disempowerment costs South Asia about 30% of its regional GDP. Realizing women's economic potential requires overcoming social norms, unpaid care burdens, and structural labour market barriers. Gender inclusion must be intentionally integrated into laws, public policies, institutions, and trade instruments at scale. Global gender-responsive trade policy has evolved from declaratory language into institutionalized mechanisms within regional trade agreements.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Why charging for UPI changes the math

The Unified Payments Interface is shifting from a zero-charge model to a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate on specified merchant payments above Rs 2,000. The Union Finance Ministry notified that the National Payments Corporation of India will levy this fee to fund the resilience of payment networks. Banks and payment providers require a steady income to maintain, secure and expand UPI infrastructure against failures. Consumers are not charged directly, but merchants will pay the MDR on specified transactions starting from October 15.

The Hindu

GS3 Best of Opinion: Will GST Council meet give process reforms a push?

The piece serves as a summary opinion roundup tied to current national policy deliberations and upcoming administrative meetings. An editorial examines policy trade-offs, institutional capacity, and the push for GST simplification alongside other economic issues. From India-US trade negotiations and Maharashtra's drought to GST simplification and public-capital governance, today's pieces examine policy trade-offs and institutional capacity

Business Standard

GS2 Moscow Format has become a talk-shop. Afghanistan is receding from global agenda

The eighth edition of the Moscow Format Consultations on Afghanistan concluded in Moscow with multiple regional nations participating, but failed to issue a joint statement for the first time. Tensions between Pakistan and Afghanistan prevented consensus, as Pakistan accused the Taliban regime of complicity in terrorism while the Taliban objected. Russia regretted the outcome but stated the format would continue to function even without a final document.

ThePrint

GS3 Eyes on ice: On the Nobel Prize for physics

Belgian-born scientist Francis Halzen won the Nobel Prize in physics for his efforts to demystify a rare group of cosmic neutrinos. Halzen first published about cosmic neutrinos in 2013 and spent his career trying to prove that neutrino astronomy is possible. Neutrinos are tiny cosmic particles with no electric charge and extraordinarily small mass, making them extremely difficult to detect. Halzen had the original idea to turn the vast Antarctic ice into a giant particle detector to catch neutrino collisions.

The Hindu

GS3 GST's next reform should be about making tax compliance easier for businesses

India launched its biggest indirect-tax reform, the goods and services tax (GST), over nine years ago with a constitutional body called the GST Council. The GST Council met 18 times prior to the rollout, but the frequency of its meetings has declined significantly over the years. The 57th meeting of the GST Council in New Delhi is scheduled to focus on procedural reforms rather than rate changes.

ThePrint

GS2 App takedown curtails free speech

Apple removed Jack Dorsey's Bitchat from the India App store following a government order issued by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology. The takedown order under Section 69(A) of the Information Technology Act, 2000 targets ongoing protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Bitchat is an open-source, Bluetooth-driven messaging app that allows end-to-end encrypted communication without internet connectivity. Protesters under the Cockroach Janta Party used Bitchat during their Jantar Mantar agitation in July after the government shut down the internet.

Deccan Herald

GS3 RBI finally gets uppity, takes a hike

The RBI took this proactive monetary policy action to tackle rising inflation amid fluctuating energy prices. The Reserve Bank of India has raised interest rates by 25 basis points to 5.5% to combat soaring inflation. Despite facing obstacles like fluctuating energy prices, India's economy is projected to show resilience. The central bank's strategy is now one of calibrated tightening, allowing adjustments based on fresh economic insights.

Economic Times

GS2 Mint Quick Edit | The Mecca alliance versus Iran-backed Houthis: Will it escalate conflict?

The trilateral Mecca pact and the actions of Pakistan and Türkiye regarding Iran-backed Houthis put the alliance in the news. An editorial discussing how the involvement of Pakistan and Türkiye in defending Saudi Arabia via the Mecca pact could escalate the West Asian conflict. Pakistan and Türkiye acting in defence of Saudi Arabia could broaden West Asia's theatre of war. How this works out for the global oil market may depend on how Iran reacts to the trilateral Mecca pact's all-for-one clause being invoked.

Mint

GS3 No one loves a good drought, yet policy waits for one

The piece appeared in the Deccan Herald opinion section, highlighting persistent policy inertia regarding water resource management. The editorial discusses how Indian agricultural and water policies react only during severe droughts instead of implementing preventive, long-term reforms.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Modest rate hike cycle commences

Renewed tensions in West Asia and a weakened agricultural outlook prompted the MPC to revise its projections. The Monetary Policy Committee has commenced a modest rate hike cycle following upward revisions to inflation projections. Weakened agricultural outlook, renewed tensions in West Asia prompt MPC to raise inflation projections

BusinessLine

GS2 A roadmap for India-China consensus: Testing the boundary framework on measurable terms

It appeared in the Deccan Herald opinion section on October 7, 2026, addressing ongoing bilateral diplomatic discourse. The editorial outlines a strategic roadmap for India and China to resolve boundary issues using measurable and verifiable metrics. A roadmap for India-China consensus

Deccan Herald

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

India-Switzerland Relationship – Significance & Challenges India and Switzerland recently signed mobility agreements to facilitate longer-duration visas and promote young professional exchanges, alongside defense and nuclear energy cooperation. Switzerland is an important economic partner for India, offering foreign investment, advanced technology, financial services, and integration into global value chains.
ForumIAS

Nobel Prize in Chemistry 2026: What this year's winners have done, why it matters The Nobel Committee announced the 2026 Chemistry laureates in October 2026. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry honors exceptional scientific contributions that advance the understanding and application of chemical research.
Indian Express

Why is the price of rice rising across the country? Rising rice prices across the country prompted the government to issue this strategic crop advisory. The central government has advised States to encourage farmers to shift from water-intensive rice cultivation to short-duration crops like pulses and millets.
The Hindu

The Nobel for IceCube and the search for neutrinos from outer space The announcement of the Nobel Prize in Physics recognized the contributions of Francis Halzen and the IceCube observatory. Francis Halzen won the Nobel Prize in Physics for his work on the IceCube Neutrino Observatory, which detects elusive cosmic neutrinos.
The Hindu

How did a Pakistan-linked spy network target Navy's Eastern Command, and how was it cracked? Security agencies cracked the espionage ring, bringing to light the targeting of the Navy's Eastern Command with 18 suspects under probe. A Pakistan-linked spy network used fake Facebook profiles to honey-trap Indian naval personnel and extract sensitive information about ship and submarine movements.
The Hindu

2026 Physics Nobel: The science of 'neutrinos', 'ghost' particles that can reveal universe's mysteries The topic is in the news following the announcement of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics. The 2026 Physics Nobel Prize honors groundbreaking research on neutrinos, the elusive ghost particles that hold clues to the universe's origins.
Indian Express

Why are Indian and U.S. leaders cooling off on a trade deal? Statements from leaders on both sides indicate that bilateral trade talks are cooling off and facing significant delays. Trade negotiations for an interim trade agreement and a comprehensive Bilateral Trade Agreement between India and the U.S. have stalled.
The Hindu

Mint Explainer: South India pins hope on northeast monsoon for rainfall relief The region is looking towards the northeast monsoon for crucial rainfall relief. South India depends heavily on the northeast monsoon for its seasonal rainfall relief and agricultural needs.
Mint

Rate hike was expected. But RBI reinforces hints that more are coming The RBI reinforced its hawkish stance during the latest monetary policy review, pointing to further rate hikes. The Reserve Bank of India executed an expected interest rate hike and strongly signaled that more rate increases are on the way.
Indian Express

Mint Explainer | GST Council meeting: what could change for refunds, enforcement and rate changes The scheduled GST Council meeting brought tax refund, enforcement, and rate policies into focus. An overview of the upcoming GST Council meeting agenda focusing on potential revisions to tax refunds, enforcement, and rates.
Mint

Account aggregator 'interoperability':What RBI's move means for asset statement The Reserve Bank of India announced the move to enable interoperability within the account aggregator framework. The RBI has introduced interoperability in the account aggregator ecosystem, enabling seamless data sharing and financial asset consolidation across different platforms. The initiative will also enable SEBI-regulated depositories to include bank deposit information in consolidated account statements.
ForumIAS

How RBI's rate hike turns homeownership dream into bigger debt burden The topic is in the news due to recent RBI rate adjustments affecting housing loan EMIs and tenures. An explanation of how increases in the Reserve Bank of India policy rates escalate borrowing costs and debt burdens for home loan holders.
Indian Express

Will ECI minutes become a record citizens can use? The ECI made a promise to issue meeting minutes, prompting a debate on whether these records will genuinely benefit citizens through public disclosure. An explainer examining whether the Election Commission of India's promise to issue meeting minutes will become a transparent, publicly accessible record that captures member decisions and dissent.
Frontline

Ebola death recorded in Kenya after victim travelled from DRC The confirmation of the travel-related Ebola death in Kenya brings immediate focus to cross-border disease surveillance. An Ebola death has been recorded in Kenya involving an individual who had traveled from the Democratic Republic of Congo.
The Hindu

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Supreme Court to hear Centre's contempt plea against appointment of Jharkhand DGP Tadasha Mishra (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench
- RBI moves to quell forex reporting confusion, says individuals need not report imports, export earnings (Economy) Economic Times
- Failure to finalise US trade deal may hurt India, but new FTAs can cushion tariff blow: RBI chief (Economy) The Hindu
- Departmental Summit on Women and Child Development to be held in New Delhi on 8-9 October (Social Justice & Welfare) PIB
- PM Surya Ghar Scheme Crosses 60-Lakh Household Mark as Rooftop Solar Push Gains Pace (Infrastructure & Energy) Republic World
- India, Italy discuss measures to strengthen counter-terrorism cooperation (International Relations) Social News XYZ
- Act against illegal resorts and homestays in tiger reserves: Ramalinga Reddy (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Document on "Strategy for Environmental Economic Accounts in India 2026-2030" (Economy) PIB
- Odisha govt forms SEBC Commission; Orissa HC retired judge Justice Pramath Patnaik appointed Chairman (Polity & Constitution) KalingaTV
- Hical & Safran MoU: Rafale Systems Manufacturing in India (Defence) Rediff MoneyWiz
- Pointing to Indus Water Treaty, Karnataka signals intent to reopen Cauvery water consensus (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- UPI Data Could Track India's Education and Healthcare Activity Under MoSPI Proposal (Governance & Policy) Thekanal
- India's UNESCO Tentative List Expands to 78 Properties with 5 New Heritage Additions in 2026 (History, Art & Culture) Jagranjosh.com
- MAHE, Google India sign pact on AI adoption (Education) The Hindu
- Lakhpati Didi scheme boosts household income: IIM Study (Social Justice & Welfare) Economic Times
- Southwest monsoon rainfall in Karnataka is second lowest in 70 years and seventh lowest in 125 years (Geography) The Hindu
- Humid heat challenges India's conventional heatwave thresholds (Environment & Ecology) Mongabay India
- A new rate game begins. What's inside the RBI's new playbook? (Economy) Economic Times
- GST Council to focus on auto refunds, swifter ITC, fewer notices (Economy) Economic Times
- DPDP (Removal of Difficulties) Order 2026 Clarifies Consent and Data Audit Requirements in India (Polity & Constitution) India Briefing
- 9 coastal panchayats in Keralam equipped for UNSECO assessment as 'tsunami-ready' (Disaster Management) The Hindu
- India proposes 3-part truce amid Russia-Ukraine war to keep grain, energy flowing (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- Four horsemen of economic trouble? RBI governor flags the risks spooking the world (Economy) Economic Times
- India's trade caught in the middle (Economy) The Hindu
- 'Rivers once destroyed cannot be compensated': Supreme Court expands probe into illegal sand mining (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- NFHS-6 Fact Sheets highlight health gains, support government's data harmonisation drive (Governance & Policy) DD News
- Piyush Goyal hails India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement coming into force today (International Relations) DD News
- Cabinet clears ITLA to coordinate transport infrastructure planning across sectors (Infrastructure & Energy) PSU Watch
- Supreme Court Upholds Levy of Excise Duty on Processed Fabrics (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Datanomics: Tax collections dip in August as direct tax receipts fall (Economy) Business Standard
- "India's governance challenges increasingly demand domain expertise, while its administrative architecture continues to privilege generalist experience." Examine the generalist-specialist debate in the higher civil services. Assess the role of lateral entry in ad (Governance & Policy) Insights on India
- Pakistani spy module honey-trapped many, including Navy sailor, in Andhra Pradesh: Cops (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Shiv Sena Row | Supreme Court Questions ECI Using 'Legislative Majority' Test, Asks Why Official Symbol... (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Safran Proposes 'Aravalli-Style' Co-Development for India's 120kN AMCA Mk2 Engine (Defence) Defence.in
- India pursuing programme to develop jet engine: Rajnath (Defence) Hindustan Times
- Chamkharchhu-I Hydropower Project (International Relations) Vajiram & Ravi
- Why the challenge to the Election Commissioners law must be heard by five judges (Polity & Constitution) Supreme Court Observer
- Command Hospital Kolkata Administers Indigenous CAR-T Therapy (Health) GKToday
- PM Narendra Modi calls for Rules-Based Maritime Order in Message to 3rd Sagarmanthan Dialogue (International Relations) PIB
- How India Turned Its Oldest Sri Lankan Adversary into a Strategic Partner (International Relations) Sri Lanka Guardian
- DRDO's HAPS: India tests indigenous high-altitude airship that could fill the gap between drones and satellites (Science & Technology) India Sentinels

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 12 must-know, 18 Prelims facts, 41 in the news, 18 editorials, 14 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (7), Environment & Ecology (6), Governance & Policy (4), International Relations (4), Polity & Constitution (2), Health (2), Defence (2), Agriculture & Allied (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Science & Technology (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Infrastructure & Energy, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 4 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 5 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 36 of 62 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 10, PIB 8, Economic Times 6, Mint 5, Hindustan Times 4, Indian Express 4, ForumIAS 3, Deccan Herald 3, BusinessLine 2, Business Standard 2, RBI 2, ThePrint 2, Ministry of External Affairs 1, ddnews.gov.in 1

Built 04 Nov 2026, 00:02 IST by UPSC Intel. Notes quote the reports; check the source before quoting a figure in an answer.